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Soccer Moms (and a Dad)

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Soccer Moms (and a Dad)

By Clint Wooderson

Synopsis: Matt (the dad) gets talked into coaching his son's soccer team. While neither the dad nor child are excited about the season, the moms provide enthusiasm, but not always in a productive manner! Join our soccer coach in discovering why little league soccer isn't all fun and games!

A 10-Minute Comedy

CAST OF CHARACTERS

MATT (m) ……. A dad that gets volunteered to coach his son's soccer team.
NICOLE (f)..... Matt's wife tells him to coach.
TIMMY (m) ……. Matt and Nicole's son that only speaks to complain about playing soccer.
ABBY (f)……..… A soccer mom that speaks on behalf of her daughter, Sydney.
BRITTANY (f)... Another soccer mom that speaks for her son, Chandler.
CHELSEA (f) … Another soccer mom that is especially prissy and speaks for her son, William.
REFEREE (m)..... Officiates the game.

Scene 1

NICOLE: Guess what?! I got a call from the youth league today and Timmy is signed up to play soccer this spring! Isn't that exciting!

MATT: Yeah, it will be fun to watch the kids run around the field in a cluster not knowing what the heck they are doing. I sure feel bad for the dad that gets stuck coaching that 5-year-old and under team though.

NICOLE: Yeah...about that. One thing that the league mentioned was that they are short on volunteers and wanted to know if we would be interested in coaching.

MATT: Oh...no. I'm swamped at work and let's be honest, I'm not very good with little kids. Feel free to volunteer if you want though.

NICOLE: I told them you would coach Timmy's team.

MATT: You did what?!

NICOLE: You played sports when you were in school.

MATT: I played basketball and ran track! I've never played soccer a day in my life!

NICOLE: Honey, they are 3 to 5-year-olds. They know nothing about soccer. I'm sure you'll be great!

MATT: You played soccer in college! Wouldn't you be a more logical choice?

NICOLE: I need to be available to organize the moms. You know that the snack rotation is a very important part of little league soccer. I will organize those details if you will take care of the coaching.

MATT: Fine. I guess you are right. I've got to know more than preschoolers about soccer. You just make sure to take care of the moms.

Scene 2: The First Practice

MATT: Welcome everyone. I'll be the coach this season. I don't have a lot of soccer experience, but we'll focus on having a good time. How about we circle up and each introduce ourselves.

ABBY: Hi! Sorry to interrupt but I'm Sydney's mom. She is very shy so it would be better if I introduced her.

MATT: Um...ok. The point of this is for the kids to get to know each other though. It might be better if she spoke for herself.

ABBY: No. I will speak for her.

MATT: Well...will you introduce her then?

ABBY: I just said her name was Sydney. Weren't you paying attention?

MATT: Right. Ok. Moving on. (Points to another child). What's your name?

BRITTANY: His name is Chandler. I'm his mom.

MATT: Great. Is Chandler able to speak for himself?

BRITTANY: Yes, but I thought the moms were going to be introducing their kids.

MATT: No, I would really like it if the children would introduce themselves so that they could get to know each other better.

BRITTANY: Oh, I like that idea. How about we do some type of introductory activity so that the kids can get to know each other?

MATT: Yes, that is a great idea (*sarcastically*). Why didn't I think of that?

CHELSEA*:* My child's name is William. I too think that an introductory activity is a good idea. Why don't we make some bracelets with the kids' names on them so that they will be easily identified?

ABBY: Great idea!

MATT: Yes, great idea, but we are here to play soccer, not do arts and crafts. Let's scrap the name idea and line up in two lines. Girls on one side and boys on the other side.

BRITTANY: That sounds sexist. My daughter is just as capable as any boy.

MATT: I'm just looking for an easy way to separate the children into two lines. I know that the girls will be just as good as the boys. Ok...kids. I want you to run up to the ball, one at a time, and kick it into the goal. Any questions?

TIMMY: Can I go to the bathroom?

MATT: You went right before we left the house. Try to hold it.

TIMMY: I don't want to play soccer! I want to go home! (starts to cry)

MATT: The whole reason I'm out here is because it was your idea to play soccer. You can quit after the season is over, but you will endure this with me (said with a snarl in his voice).

ABBY: I don't appreciate the way you spoke to that little boy.

MATT: It's my own "little boy" so leave me alone. I'll speak nicer to your daughter, but I'll probably have to go through you as her interpreter anyway!

ABBY: Well, I never! I don't think you are a very good influence on my daughter!

MATT: Sorry *(ignoring her / rolling his eyes).* Ok, kids let's practice actually kicking the ball!

Scene 3: The First Game

REFEREE*:* Welcome to the first game of the season. Remember, we are here to have fun. Kids, do your best and play nice. On the whistle, we'll begin.

MATT: *(on the sidelines coaching the kids)* Alright guys, let's have fun.

(The referee blows the whistle)

Spread out! Pass the ball! Don't swarm the ball! You can't all kick it at once! Spread out! It doesn't help if you are all in one big group! Spread out!!!

(Moms are in the stands)

ABBY: Why is he being so hard on them? They're just children!

NICOLE: On behalf of my husband, I want to apologize. He doesn't have any experience coaching.

BRITTANY: Why did he volunteer to coach? It seems as though it would have been better to get someone that had experience with soccer...and children.

NICOLE: That's Matt. He's always signing up for things that are beyond his ability.

CHELSEA: Maybe next year we can get someone that knows what they are doing.

NICOLE: To be fair, it was good of him to volunteer. The community league said that they were short on volunteers.

ABBY: Well, I guess.

BRITTANY: Yeah.

CHELSEA: That's true.

NICOLE: Now ladies, we need to create a snack rotation. I brought snacks for after the game today.

BRITTANY: Thank you! What did you bring? You know, Chandler has a peanut allergy, so I hope the snack doesn't have peanuts.

NICOLE: That's okay, I brought some potato chips and Gatorade.

CHELSEA: Are the potato chips baked? We are trying to watch the types of oil that William eats.

NICOLE: Umm...I don't think they are baked, sorry. I'd be happy to run to the store quickly and pick something else up though.

CHELSEA: Don't be silly. We don't want to be any trouble. I'll just be sure to be considerate of others when it is my turn to bring snacks.

NICOLE: Excuse me?

ABBY: Don't be sensitive. Chelsea just means that you probably didn't know about her son's condition. Right, Chels?

CHELSEA: Right.

NICOLE: (awkward smile) OK. We can talk more about the rotation after the game. Why don't we just enjoy watching for now?

CHELSEA: Yes, we can do business after our team's victory.

(The referee blows the whistle)

MATT: Ok, come over here. That's the end of the first half. You guys are...trying really hard. Remember, we don't need everyone on the ball in a cluster. If you guys would spread out you could pass it to each other and you would have a better chance to score.

TIMMY: I want to sit down!

MATT: Okay Timmy, sit down. Chandler, you're in for Timmy to start the second half.

BRITTANY: Did you hear that? Chandler is going to start the second half! Oh, no! The battery on my phone is about to die. How am I going to record him? Excuse me, Matt?

MATT: Yes?

BRITTANY: Do you think you could film the second half for me since my phone is about to die?

MATT: No! I'm coaching here! I don't have time to take a video!

BRITTANY: Well, aren't you snippy! I ask a simple favor from someone that is supposed to be setting an example for our children and you exhibit a very poor attitude.

ABBY: Don't worry. I'll share the video I'm taking with you. I have plenty of battery life left.

BRITTANY: Thanks, but I noticed that you are using an android. I would prefer to have a video taken with a higher quality camera.

CHELSEA: Why do they even bother making androids? If a product is not quality, it should not be produced.

ABBY: (*snarky*) Good news, at second glance I realized that my battery is dying too. I guess I won't be able to take the video.

(The referee blows the whistle)

REFEREE: Take your places to begin the second half.

MATT: Ok, guys. Remember, spread out and pass each other the ball. It will help you to score if you pass it to one another.

(The referee blows the whistle to start the second half)

MATT: Good! Nice job guys! Chandler, don't sit in the grass.

BRITTANY: Oh no! There is clover in the field and he is allergic to clover!

MATT: Chandler, don't lay down!

(Referee blows the whistle)

REFEREE: Sorry coach, but I can't allow kids to lay down in the field due to safety concerns.

MATT: I understand. Chandler, you've got to get up!

BRITTANY: Oh no! Chandler is breaking out into hives! Get him out of the game! Get him out of the game!

MATT: Okay! Okay! Chandler, get up and off to the side. Timmy, you're back in the game.

TIMMY: I don't wanna play anymore!

MATT: Get in the game!

TIMMY: No!

MATT: Fine! Ref, my team is on the field. We will just play one player short.

REFEREE: Okay.

NICOLE: Matt! What are you doing? Let Timmy play!

MATT: Let Timmy play? He doesn't want to play! I'm doing all of this for him and he doesn't even want to play!

NICOLE: I can't believe he isn't playing! You are doing a pitiful job of coaching!

MATT: I'm doing the best I can! I didn't want to coach in the first place!

NICOLE: Clearly you are proving yourself to be less than qualified. Next year, I'm not going to let you volunteer!!!

MATT: Let me volunteer?! That's it! I Quit! Have fun coaching, soccer moms! Timmy, good news. I now give you permission to quit. Let's go home!

TIMMY: Yeah!!! I need to go to the bathroom!

Playwright biography: Clint Wooderson is a high school drama and speech teacher in Missouri. Clint has coached multiple students to state and national competitions in interpretation events. He holds a doctorate in Educational Leadership and strives to provide positive educational experiences for his students.